



Commodities Outlook

Look on the bright side

Voting for this year's Extel Global Fixed Income Research Survey is open, and we would appreciate your 5-star vote in the Global Commodities category ([Link](#)).

Challenging external environment is not all bad

The external environment remains a challenging one for commodities from the standpoint of geopolitical volatility, which we expect to continue. However global growth has remained resilient to the energy disruption with only minor downgrades, and we prefer not to chase recent USD strength, maintaining a bearish dollar bias into year-end. Moreover, there is a silver lining in terms of the resulting incentive to build supply resilience in both critical minerals and energy.

Precious metals: Limits to Fed hawkishness

We see limits to Fed hawkishness and its impact on **gold**. Recent moves have been orthogonal to the gold-rates regression, and the 2022 example shows that such relationships are subject to change. Speculative flows remain a headwind but we expect gold and silver higher by the end of the year as structural government debt expansion wins out over sharp but short-lived moves in rates and FX. For the **PGMs**, combined demand may drop 455 koz (3%) on weaker catalysed vehicle sales, although palladium is temporarily shielded by a one-off decline in Russian production. Large dislocations persist in **crude oil** supply, refinery runs, and crack spreads which will take at least until the end of the year to normalise. However once complete, we think the reality of a significant surplus in 2027 will become the dominant focus.

Industrial metals: macro headwinds, structural story intact

Copper prices have come under pressure from a firmer US dollar and a pull back in AI capex related equities. The supply-side remains tight and we forecast a rising profile from ~\$13,000/t in Q3 to ~\$13,600/t in Q4. An update on US copper tariffs is expected in H2 and could create volatility, depending on the outcome (refer to our [US tariffs report](#) for details). **Aluminium** prices have corrected sharply amid evidence of quicker than expected smelter restarts in the Gulf. We see scope for a modest rebound in prices in H2 (~\$3,300/t in Q4), before normalising towards ~\$3,000/t through 2027 as supply from the Gulf returns. **Iron ore** has been under pressure as the war drivers have largely unwound, while firm seaborne exports and early signs of Simandou ramp-up are reinforcing the supply headwind. We expect support from the upper end of the cost curve (>\$100/t) to limit downside during a seasonally soft summer.

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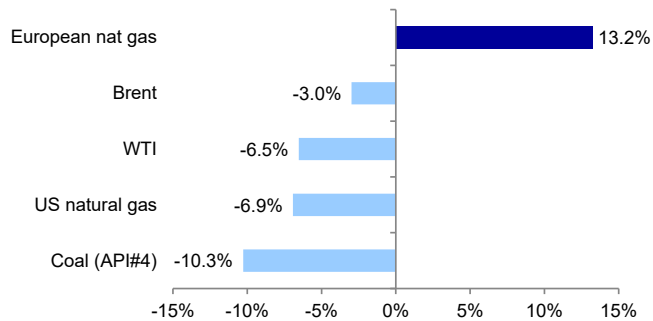
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Commodities outlook

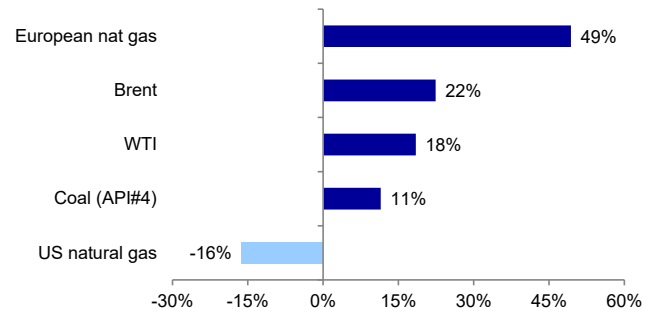
Energy

Figure 1: Last 1 month performance (%)



Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP (data as of 14-Jul-26)

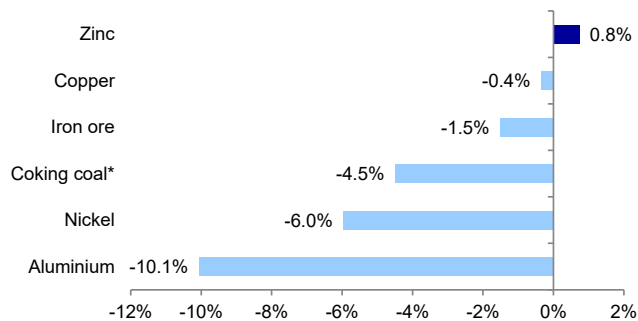
Figure 2: Last 12 months' performance (%)



Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP (data as of 14-Jul-26)

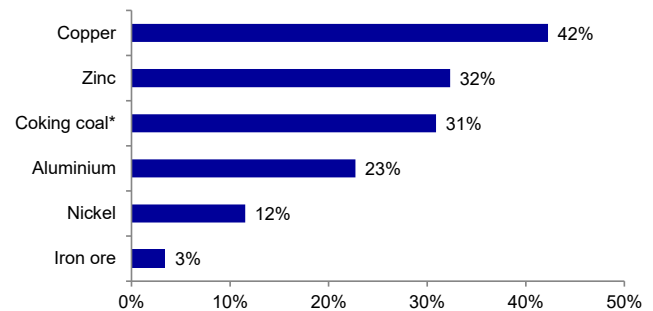
Industrial metals and ferrous

Figure 3: Last 1 month performance (%)



Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP (data as of 14-Jul-26). Coking coal represent 1m Futures

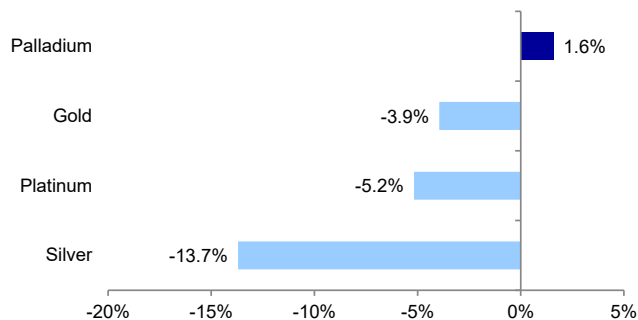
Figure 4: Last 12 months' performance (%)



Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP (data as of 14-Jul-26). Coking coal represent 1m Futures

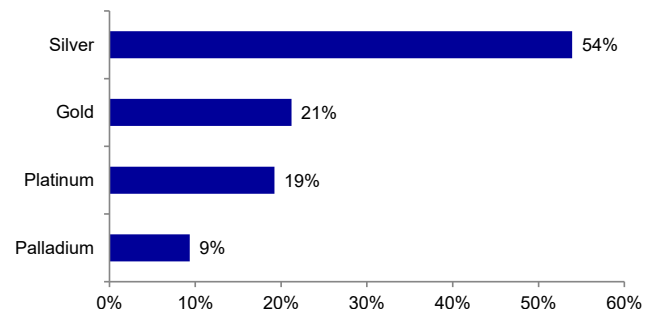
Precious metals

Figure 5: Last 1 month performance (%)



Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP (data as of 14-Jul-26)

Figure 6: Last 12 months' performance (%)



Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP (data as of 14-Jul-26)



Deutsche Bank commodity price forecasts

Figure 7: Base metals price forecasts

USD/t	2024	2025	Q1 26	Q2 26	Q3 26	Q4 26	2026	2027	2028	Spot
Aluminium (US\$/lb)	109.8	119.3	145.1	161.7	145.1	149.7	150.4	144.0	136.1	144.1
USD/t	2,420	2,631	3,198	3,565	3,200	3,300	3,316	3,175	3,000	3,177
% Change					-20.0%	-13.2%	-9.4%	-10.6%	-6.3%	
Copper (US\$/lb)	414.9	451.3	581.7	604.8	589.7	616.9	598.3	567.0	569.6	616.7
USD/t	9,146	9,949	12,824	13,333	13,000	13,600	13,189	12,500	12,558	13,596
% Change					4.0%	8.8%	3.2%	4.2%	13.2%	
Zinc (US\$/lb)	126.0	130.0	146.8	156.9	154.2	154.2	153.1	145.1	137.7	163.5
USD/t	2,777	2,866	3,237	3,460	3,400	3,400	3,374	3,200	3,035	3,605
% Change					13.3%	13.3%	6.5%	10.3%	7.4%	

Source: Deutsche Bank estimates; Figures are period averages. Q3 26 to 2028 are our forecasts. Aluminium price changes in comparison to the "Global Aluminium" report published on 1 June 2026. Copper and zinc price changes in comparison to the "Pricing Update" report published on 14 April 2026.

Figure 8: Oil price forecasts

USD	2024	2025	Q1 26	Q2 26	Q3 26	Q4 26	2026	2027	2028	Spot
WTI (bbl)	75.8	64.9	72.3	92.5	77.0	72.0	78.5	67.0	73.3	79.9
% Change					6.9%	7.5%	3.3%	0.0%	0.0%	
Brent (bbl)	79.9	68.2	78.4	96.7	80.0	75.0	82.5	70.0	76.4	85.3
% Change					6.7%	7.1%	3.1%	0.0%	0.0%	

Source : Deutsche Bank estimates; Figures are period averages. Q3 26 to 2028 are our forecasts. Price change in comparison to the "Hsueh on Oil" report published on 6 July 2026.

Figure 9: Iron ore and coking coal price forecasts

USD/t	2024	2025	Q1 26	Q2 26	Q3 26	Q4 26	2026	2027	2028	Spot
Iron Ore 61% Fines CFR	110	102	104	105	98	100	102	100	99	99
% Change					0.0%	0.0%	-0.4%	0.0%	0.0%	
Premium HCC	244	188	232	238	230	230	233	225	220	233
% Change					7.0%	0.0%	1.8%	0.0%	0.0%	
Newcastle thermal FOB	136	106	120	137	135	130	131	130	120	128
% Change					-3.6%	0.0%	-0.6%	0.0%	0.0%	

Source: Deutsche Bank estimates; Figures are period averages. Q3 26 to 2028 are our forecasts. Prior to 2026, iron ore prices were marked to market based on the 62% Fe benchmark price. Price changes in comparison to the "Pricing Update" report published on 14 April 2026.



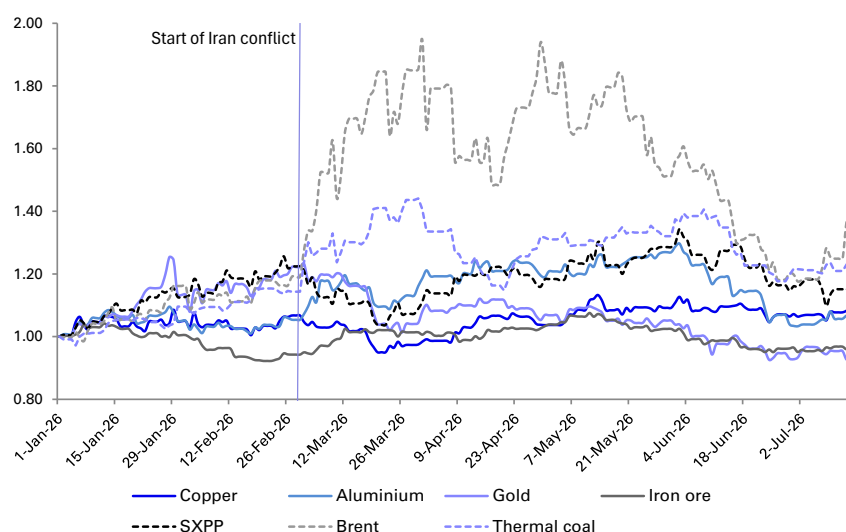
Figure 10: Precious metals price forecasts

USD/oz	2024	2025	Q1 26	Q2 26	Q3 26	Q4 26	2026	2027	2028	Spot
Gold	2,387	3,440	4,873	4,508	4,300	4,600	4,570	5,100	5,442	4,033
% Change					0.0%	-4.2%	-1.1%	-3.8%	0.0%	
Silver	28.2	40.1	83.9	73.1	65.0	70.0	73.0	77.5	78.5	58.0
% Change					0.0%	-4.1%	-1.0%	-3.7%	-6.2%	
Platinum	956	1,283	2,204	1,915	1,720	1,840	1,920	2,040	2,300	1,623
% Change					0.0%	-4.2%	-1.0%	-3.8%	0.0%	
Palladium	983	1,151	1,706	1,408	1,300	1,390	1,451	1,478	1,570	1,296
% Change					0.0%	-4.1%	-1.0%	-3.7%	0.0%	

Source : Deutsche Bank estimates; Figures are period averages. Q3 26 to 2028 are our forecasts. Price change in comparison to the "Precious Special Report" published on 22 June 2026.

Outlook: Challenging external environment is not all bad

Figure 11: YTD price performance trends (US\$ basis)



Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

We update our assessment of the external environment for commodities here, along the dimensions we explored in January (["Structurally higher geopolitical risk"](#)). These topics may influence commodity markets without necessarily being discussed in our individual commodity views: the geopolitical climate, the US dollar, investor positioning, and the macroeconomic picture.

(A) On geopolitics, DB's mid-year [outlook](#) sees an extension of geopolitical volatility in keeping with the idea that we have seen a structural shift. A continuation of an unpredictable and fragmented global operating environment finds expression in a number of ways.

On the US, we should expect more foreign policy volatility where incentives are increased for visible foreign policy wins. There is potential for renewed conflict in the Middle East, and difficult US-Iran negotiations are likely to extend beyond the initial 60-day period. A US-China détente does not negate the fact that the broader relationship will remain one of strategic competition, marred by mistrust and

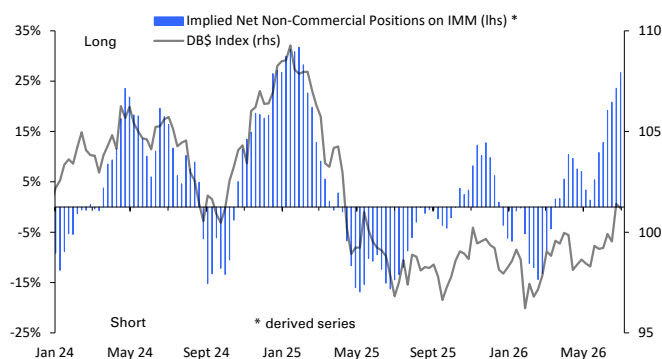


competing national security priorities. A fractured EU-US relationship means that Europe will face a possibility of renewed economic and trade clashes, and continued pressure to overcome internal divisions to build more strategic autonomy. For Ukraine, trilateral negotiations have stalled, but a winding down of the Middle East crisis could mean increased attention on a potential ceasefire and peace plan, along with possible easing of sanctions on Russia.

The most direct line of transmission to commodity markets may well be the global initiatives to build resilience in **critical mineral supply**, including both in diversification of the supply chain as well as stockpiling of reserves. In late 2025, the US signed agreements with Japan, Australia, Malaysia, Vietnam, Cambodia and Thailand. That momentum has built further with the US Project Vault (a critical minerals reserve), the US-EU Critical Minerals Plan, US-India Critical Minerals Framework, a European Critical Raw Minerals Centre, the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative Framework, and Australia's Critical Minerals Strategic Reserve all announced within the first half of this year.

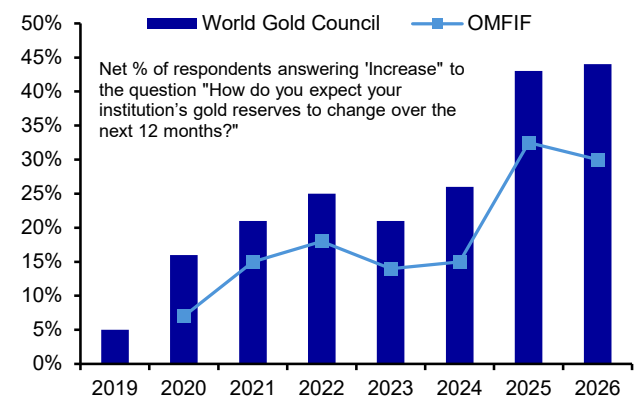
(B) On the **US dollar**, we prefer not to chase recent dollar strength which reached 1y high on the Bloomberg spot dollar index. To its credit, the US is now expected to grow the most amongst G10 economies, and its 2y and 3m rate rankings amongst G10 economies are reasonably supportive. However, hawkish Fed repricing may not support a continued uptrend given that it has gone quite far in comparison to the US core CPI overshoot ([Link](#)). Additionally we have observed a very strong positioning move, with net long positioning similar to January 2025 when the DXY index level was some 6-7% stronger ([Link](#)). We see room for riskier currencies to rebound, although catalysts for broader dollar weakness inclusive of EUR and JPY are difficult to identify for now. Our forecasts have the USD moderately lower (-3.7%) on the Fed's trade-weighted broad dollar index by year-end.

Figure 12: USD implied net long positioning near 2025 high, with much lower level of DXY index



Source : CFTC, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 13: Surveys show similarly high proportion of reserve managers intend to accumulate gold over next 12 months



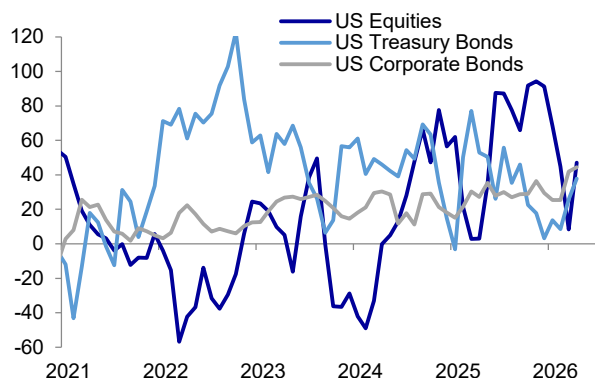
Source : World Gold Council, OMFIF



(C) The third item is **capital flows and investor positioning** where we see a more obvious inclination to pursue a de-dollarisation agenda amongst reserve managers than private investors. In the OMFIF's Global Public Investor survey data, more reserve managers expressed a long-term (10y) intention to decrease (24%) than increase (16%) USD exposure, with a majority (60%) intending to maintain USD exposure.

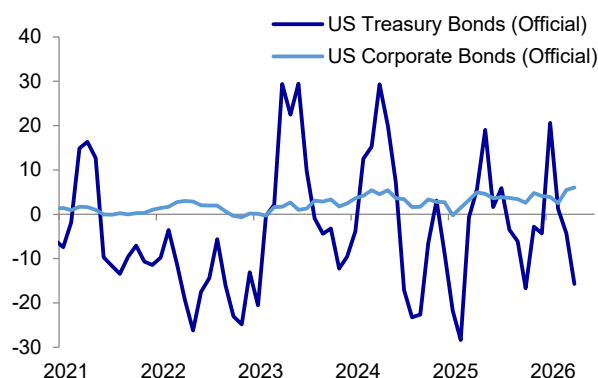
On the other hand, private investor activity shows very little obvious divergence from past history, although such a judgment that it *has* diverged is difficult given that investment activity has turned negative for substantial periods and then reversed to positive. For example, public investors were net sellers of US Treasury bonds between 2015-2020, and private investors were sizeable net sellers of US equities in 2022 and 2024. In those instances, one could not necessarily have differentiated intentions between de-dollarisation and a view on the asset class, for instance. The difference now is that earlier this year, we have heard from major private investment entities that they would be pursuing diversification from US assets. Yet the aggregate data for both private and public investors does not clearly suggest anything of the sort.

Figure 14: Private investor net foreign investment in US assets (3m avg monthly rate, USD bn)



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, US Treasury, Deutsche Bank

Figure 15: Public investor net foreign investment in US assets (3m avg monthly rate, USD bn)



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, US Treasury, Deutsche Bank

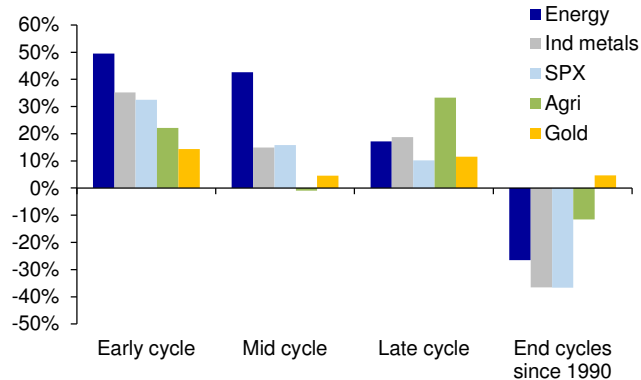
(D) For the **macroeconomic climate**, our team notes from the World Outlook that the world economy grapples with a complex interplay of persistent AI-driven optimism and the disruptive force of the Middle East conflict. The trend of median forecasts has been moving lower since March, but it is fair to say that the degree of movement has been relatively modest from the perspective of the median analyst as compiled by Bloomberg.

To reinforce the framing of the growth outlook provided by DB's World Outlook as one shaped by AI investment and the Middle East conflict, differing emphases on these themes help to explain the difference between the OECD's June estimate of 2026 global growth at 2.8%, and the more optimistic IMF July estimate at 3.0%. The IMF commentary observes that "the effects of the war in the Middle East [are] being partly offset by accelerated demand-driven momentum in the global technology



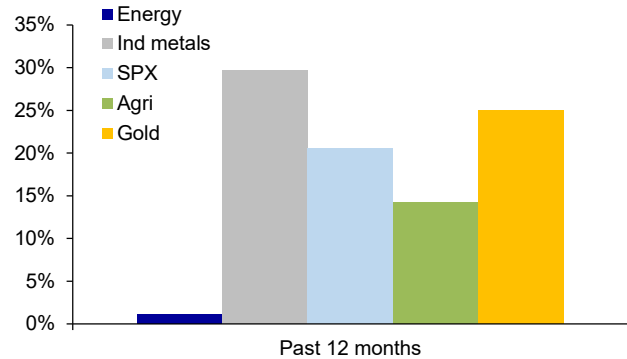
cycle thanks to advances in artificial intelligence (AI) and its adoption."¹ On the other hand the OECD sees the conflict in the Middle East as the "dominant force shaping the global economic outlook"², inclusive of its effects on the price and volume of energy, agricultural, and industrial inputs. The IMF is also more sanguine on the 2027 outlook with an upgrade from 3.2% to 3.4%, while the OECD maintained its 3.1% projection (DB 3.2%).

Figure 16: Commodity performance across the US economic cycle



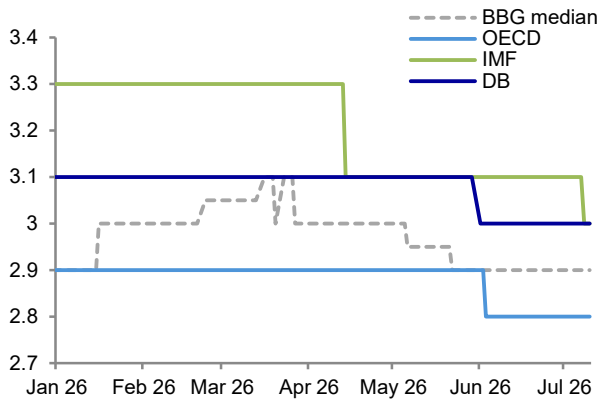
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 17: Commodity performance in last 12 months



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 18: World growth forecasts peaked in March



Source : IMF, OECD, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

1 "World Economic Outlook Update: Global Economy in Crosscurrents of War and Technology", IMF, 3 July 2026, (https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/oecd-economic-outlook-volume-2026-issue-1_2d1956f0-en.html)
2 "OECD Economic Outlook, Volume 2026 Issue 1", OECD, 3 June 2026, (https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/oecd-economic-outlook-volume-2026-issue-1_2d1956f0-en.html)



Figure 19: DB GDP growth forecasts

Real GDP (% YoY)	WO June 2026				Change versus November World Outlook		Bloomberg Consensus (9-Jul-26)	
	2024	2025	2026	2027	2026	2027	2026	2027
World	3.4	3.2	3.0	3.2	-0.1	0.1	2.9	3.1
US	2.8	2.1	2.2	2.2	-0.2	0.1	2.1	2.1
Euro Area	0.9	1.5	0.5	1.1	-0.6	-0.2	0.6	1.2
Germany	-0.5	0.2	0.5	1.3	-1.0	-0.3	0.6	1.1
UK	1.0	1.4	1.0	1.2	-0.2	-0.2	1.0	1.1
Japan	-0.2	1.1	0.7	0.7	-0.2	-0.2	0.6	0.8
Australia	1.0	2.0	2.2	1.4	-0.2	-0.8	1.9	1.7
Canada	2.0	1.9	0.6	1.6	-0.3	-0.1	0.7	1.9
China	5.0	5.0	4.7	4.5	0.2	0.2	4.6	4.4
India	7.2	7.5	6.7	7.2	0.3	0.5	7.5	6.6
South Korea	2.0	1.0	2.9	2.3	0.9	0.6	2.7	2.1
Russia	4.9	1.0	0.6	1.3	-0.2	-0.1	0.8	1.3
South Africa	0.5	1.1	1.4	1.4	-0.4	-0.4	1.3	1.6
Türkiye	3.3	3.6	3.0	4.5	-0.9	0.2	3.0	3.6
Brazil	3.4	2.3	1.9	1.7	0.3	-0.3	1.9	1.8
Mexico	1.4	0.6	1.2	1.8	-0.3	Unch.	1.1	1.8

Source: Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank



Key calls

Copper: structural tightness amidst tariff uncertainty

Copper prices experienced a strong price recovery from March to early June, recovering from a low of ~\$12k to a high of \$14k. In recent weeks, prices have come under pressure from a firmer US dollar and a pull back in AI capex related equities, although prices have held up better than other metals due to relatively tight micro trends. We expect prices to remain range bound in the near-term before rebounding to ~\$13,600/t in Q4. As we detail in our [2026 Outlook](#), we believe an incentive price regime is here to stay, supported by inelastic mine supply, electrification-linked demand drivers, and high greenfield capex. We assume some moderation in prices in 2027 (to ~\$12,500/t) on a recovery in global mine supply following a heavily disrupted 2025/26.

The market is still eagerly awaiting an update from the US government on copper tariffs. Under the President's Proclamation, the Commerce Secretary was required to provide an update on domestic copper markets by 30 June 2026, with a subsequent decision on refined copper tariffs expected thereafter. We recently published a report outlining three [possible policy paths](#): (1) a phased introduction of tariffs (15% in 2027 rising to 30% in 2028); this is the market's base case and would be positive for copper near-term. (2) Immediate tariffs; this would effectively shut down US import flows and could put downward pressure on LME prices. (3) No tariffs; this could trigger a sharp sell-off given elevated US inventories.

Aluminium: supply recovery

Aluminium prices reached a peak of ~\$3,850/t in early June following the Middle East supply shock, which temporarily removed an estimated ~2.5-3.0 mtpa of primary aluminium capacity (3-4% of global primary supply). This also tightened regional markets and drove physical premiums sharply higher. However, prices have subsequently retreated towards ~\$3,100/t following the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz as bullish positioning has partly unwound and on reports of faster ramp ups in the Gulf.

With inventories low and supply still expected to be weak in H2, we see scope for a modest recovery in prices through H2 (DB ~\$3,300/t in Q4) followed by a gradual normalisation back towards ~\$3,000/t through 2027. Aluminium producers in the Middle East have fared better than expected, and recent channel checks suggest smelters in the Gulf are ramping up quickly. A key surprise is at the Al Taweelah smelter, where the alumina refinery has already restarted (and ramp-up to full alumina production is expected by year end) and the company is believed to be 'jump-starting' some pots at the smelter. This has, in turn, narrowed our estimated 2026 market deficit from > 2 mt to < 1 mt with 2027 close to balanced.



Iron ore: cost curve support

Iron ore prices were pushed higher through March and April by the conflict in the Middle East, reflecting concerns over diesel availability, freight costs, and potential supply disruptions. As these concerns have moderated, prices have retreated towards ~\$100/t. While prices could move lower during the seasonally softer summer period, we expect the downside to be limited by support from the upper end of the cost curve (>\$100/t). High-frequency indicators point to softer market conditions; Chinese steel inventories have increased, steel margins remain weak, and steel output is likely to decline in the coming weeks. At the same time, strong seaborne exports and the initial ramp-up of Simandou, where shipping rates have significantly increased over recent months, are reinforcing the supply-side headwind.

Chinese policy support remains a focus area heading into the autumn. Any measures targeting infrastructure investment and/or the property sector could support steel demand expectations and improve sentiment. For 2026 as a whole, we forecast a modest iron ore surplus, weighted towards H2, as elevated port inventories, continued contraction in Chinese steel demand and incremental supply weighs on balances. We forecast average prices (CFR 61%) of ~\$98/t in Q3, ~\$100/t in Q4 and ~\$103/t for 2026.

Crude oil: Refined product tightness persists

Since President Trump declared the US-Iran memorandum of understanding defunct as of early July, the acute and re-emerging issue for the oil market is the constriction of traffic through the Strait of Hormuz. Mid-July vessel movements indicate that outbound tanker volume may have dropped from a 7-day average of 13 mmb/d as recently as 7-Jul down to less than half of that at 4 mmb/d, although very recent data is subject to revision ([Figure 86](#)). Also concerning is that fact that the capacity of inbound tankers on ballast trips has dropped even more sharply from a 7-day average of 15 mmb/d in early July to 4 mmb/d. This is a signal that shippers are now less comfortable with the risk of stranded vessels in the Gulf.

The fact that this constriction of flow has only raised the Brent price to USD 85/bbl rather than the USD 90/bbl implied by the price-to-fundamental regression ([Figure 101](#)) shows the degree to which adjustments in the system may be suppressing the rise in prices that might otherwise have occurred. This takes the form of inventory withdrawal that is visible in China turning from a build of 0.5 mmb/d to a draw of -1.0 mmb/d ([Figure 87](#)), the IEA-coordinated global SPR withdrawal estimated at 1.5 mmb/d in June, and reductions in global refinery runs of -4.8 mmb/d versus 2025 ([Figure 91](#)). This has had the side effect of transmitting some of the crude oil tightness into the refined product market, which is visible in still-elevated refining crack spreads in Europe, and even higher cracks in the US ([Figure 90](#)). On top of the above crude withdrawals, China has also switched from refined product builds of +360 kb/d to decline of -260 kb/d, making for a 620 kb/d swing.

Our projections assume that the US and Iran find a way of re-opening commercial traffic through the Strait of Hormuz, to the extent visible in late June which exceeded the 65% of normal rate required to normalise crude supply. After this point, there will likely remain a temporary barrier to normalisation in the form of still-low refinery runs, high crack spreads, and China inventory withdrawals. Reversing these dislocations should be complementary (i.e., higher refinery runs lowering crack spreads). However one complication is that Russia has been a



significant contributor to the refining disruption, and as such there is a linkage to the Russia-Ukraine conflict. All in all we assume that the majority of these dislocations resolve themselves by the end of the year, beyond which 2027 surplus of a possible +4 mmb/d will become the focal point ([Figure 88](#) and [Figure 89](#)).

Gold and silver: Limits to Fed hawkishness

Gold weakness since March has been most substantially linked to expectations of tighter monetary policy, supported by the upside risks to headline CPI from oil prices, broad-based strength in the drivers of core CPI ([Link](#)), and insurance cuts in 2025 that were shortly followed by signs of labour market strength, which widened the gap between Fed funds and policy rule prescriptions ([Link](#)). From this basic level, there are three ways of rounding out our understanding of today's gold dynamics.

First, the gold investor's framework encompasses a range of possible interactions between macro variables and policy decision-making. Where we land in this range of possibilities, suggested by the diagram in [Figure 75](#), may also help us to understand where we might be able to go. In today's world where inflation risks are more acute owing to the US-Iran war, orthodox monetary policy under Fed Chair Warsh is associated with rising real rates and a headwind for gold. The challenge coming from the macro-policy mix is that it looks difficult to shift into one of the other other boxes – either via the perception of a dovish mistake, below-potential growth, or labour market slack.

The **second** point is that gold has apparently had a much more significant reaction to higher real rates this year, as compared to the similar move in real rates in 2023, as well as the much larger move in 2022 ([Figure 76](#)). The main difference is that ETF investment was so extraordinarily strong last year, such that a return to a modestly negative year would make for quite a negative comparison year on year, [Figure 74](#).

The **third** point is that in just the last month, there has been significant room for gold fluctuation even when Fed pricing has been within a narrow range, [Figure 77](#) (i.e., gold moving orthogonal to regression line). We should be alert to the possibility that this gold-rates relationship could break down more significantly, though it is so far unclear what new driver may emerge. In 2022-23, a breakdown in the gold-Fed relationship came about because of a step-up in central bank demand. Ultimately we see limits to Fed hawkishness and its impact on gold when rates market pricing (+44 bps through Jun'27) is already near to our US Econ team's expectation of two hikes.

For the time being, both ETF and speculative futures activity have been a weight on the market ([Figure 78](#)). But over time we think gold and silver are likely to move higher owing to the longer term driver of government debt expansion as we detailed last month ([Hawks drive out bulls](#), 22 Jun), [Figure 79](#).



PGMs: Auto sales weakness on higher oil

Our update focuses on the three most salient changes to the outlook. **First**, a reduction in the estimates of new vehicle sales means that global catalysed vehicle sales could drop by -4.6% this year. This would be more than double the pace we previously projected (-1.7%), and also considerably higher than the long term trend decline of -2.5% p.a. we expect through 2035. As a result, total automotive PGM demand (Pt+Pd) may drop by -455 koz from 2025.

This is attributed almost entirely to China where catalysed vehicle sales may be down by -21% this year, or 3.3 million units. Oil-price inflation, weaker discretionary spending, and fading stimulus effects have dampened sentiment for ICE and hybrid vehicles, despite government price controls on refined products. As supporting evidence, China's National Energy Administration reported a 56% increase in highway charging activity, and 26% increase in Shanghai EV charging. According to the IEA, this demand switching is equivalent to a -400 kb/d decline in refined product consumption in May.

Second, there will be a meaningful drop this year in Russia primary palladium supply of -265 koz or nearly 10%, as Norilsk Nickel notes "mounting operational and sanctions-related pressures".³ The primary driver is a reduction in ore grades, although the replacement of Western equipment with Chinese and Belarusian machinery may also be contributing.⁴ We expect 2027 Russian production to rebound owing partly to a ramp-up at the Chernogorskoye mining and processing complex.

Third, this year has seen significant selling by platinum ETF investors, making for the second highest year of redemption in data from 2008. Altogether these three factors indicate that platinum may have moved into a modest surplus, and palladium manages to show a continued deficit owing to the Russian production shortfall. But overall these imbalances are smaller than the deficits seen in both markets over just the last five years.

Lastly we also note that 120-day correlations of both platinum and palladium to gold have been quite elevated, while 6-month betas to the USD have reached the highest in data since 2000. This suggests that weaker fundamentals owing to auto sales may also have been accentuated by USD strength and gold price weakness.

3 "Russia's Norinickel Reports Sharp First-Quarter Drop in Metal Output", Moscow Times, 28 Apr 2026, <https://www.themoscowtimes.com/2026/04/28/russias-nornickel-reports-sharp-first-quarter-drop-in-metal-output-a92628>.

4 "Russia's Norinickel Sees Lower Palladium Output as Grades Decline", Bloomberg Finance LP, 28 Jan 2026, <https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-01-28/russia-s-nornickel-sees-lower-palladium-output-as-grades-decline>



Commodities in charts

China and LME inventory snapshot

Figure 20: Copper inventory

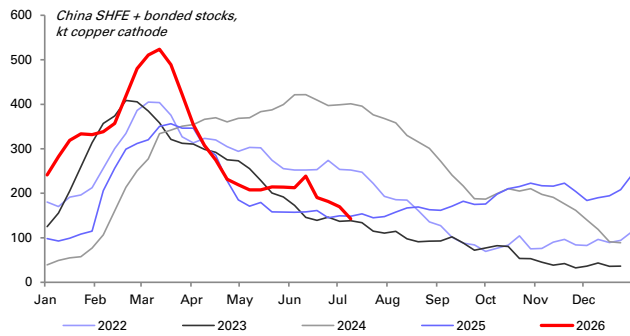


Figure 21: Aluminium inventory

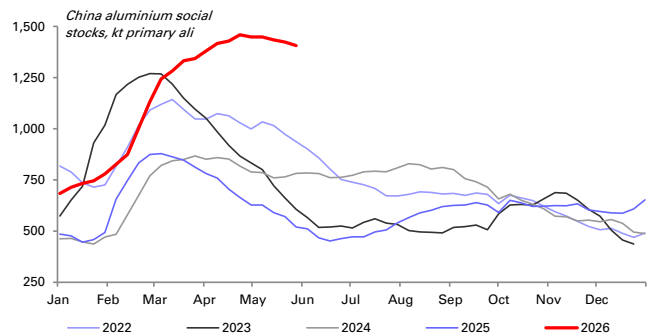


Figure 22: Zinc inventory

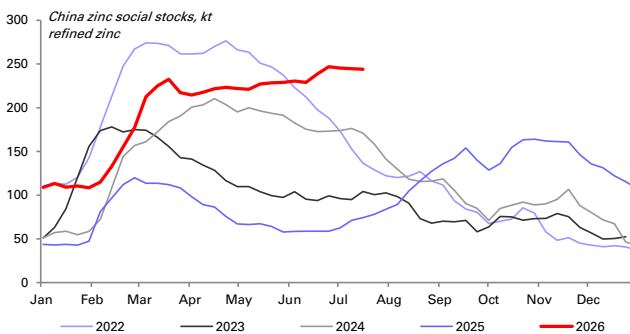


Figure 23: Steel inventory

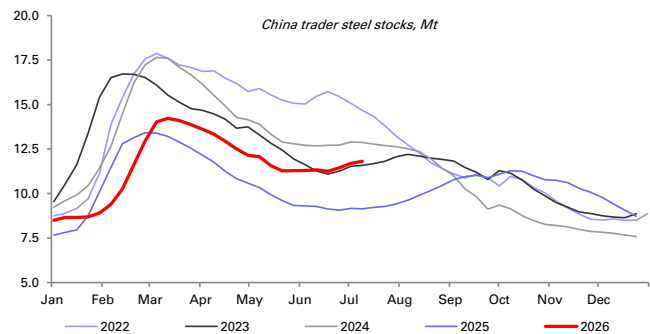


Figure 24: Iron ore port stocks

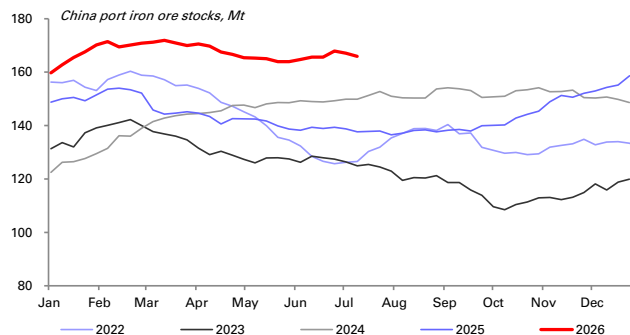
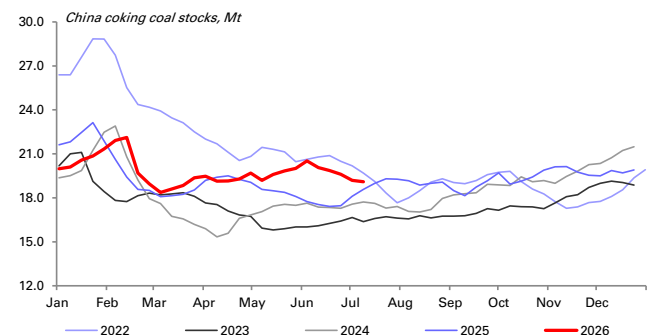


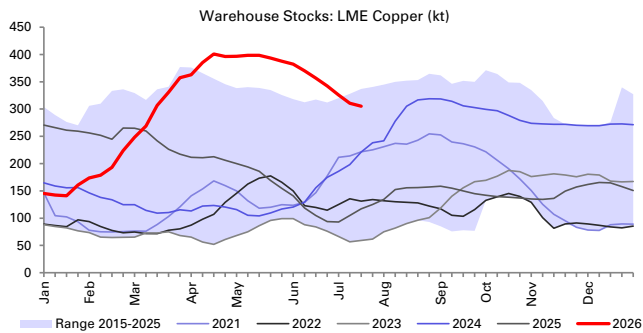
Figure 25: Coking coal stocks





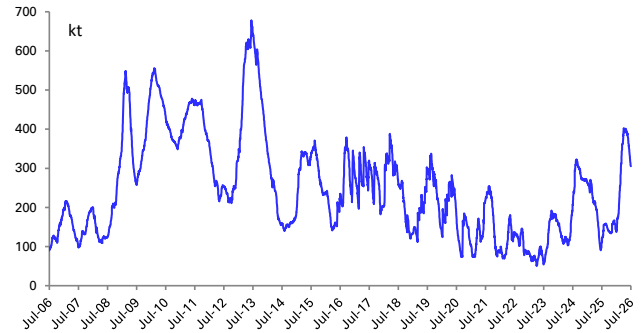
LME inventories

Figure 26: Copper



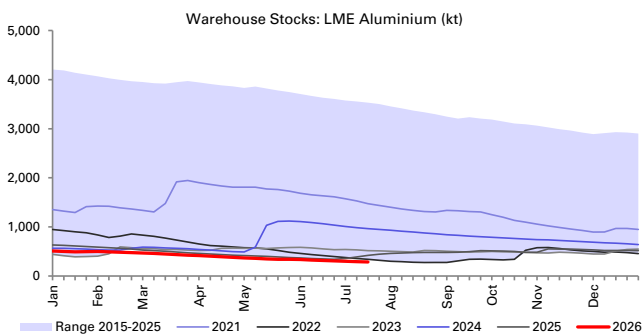
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 27: Copper – 20 years



Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 28: Aluminium



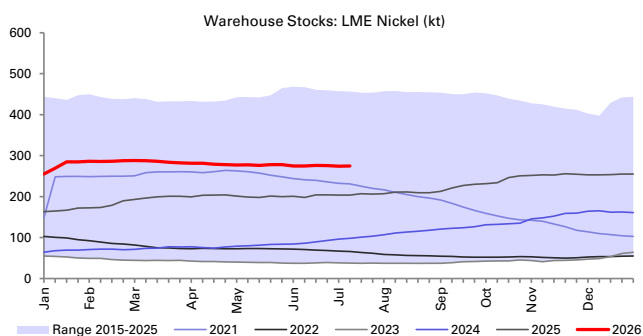
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 29: Aluminium – 20 years



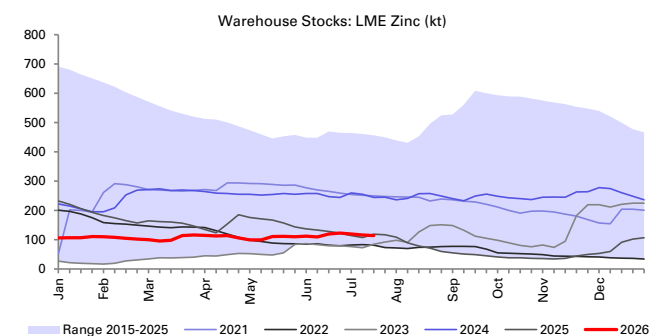
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 30: Nickel



Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 31: Zinc



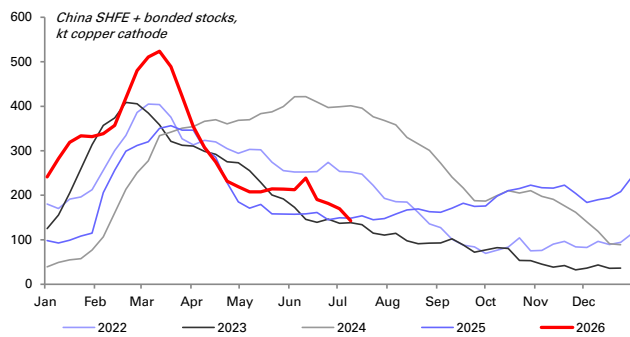
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP



Copper: refined surplus, mine supply deficit

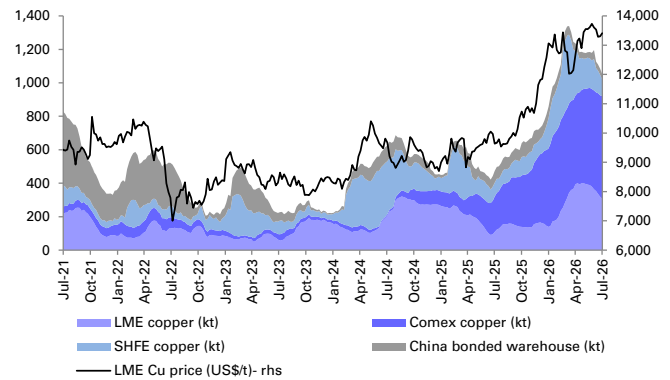
Inventory and high-frequency trends

Figure 32: China inventories



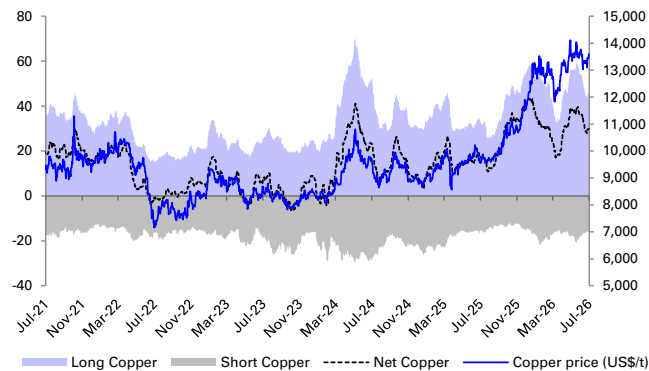
Source : Deutsche Bank, Wind

Figure 33: Global inventories



Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 34: Copper positioning



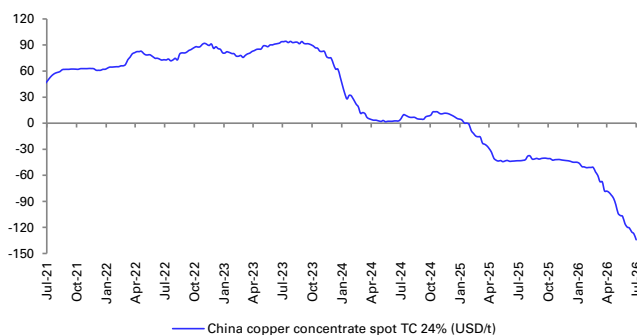
Source : CFTC, LME, Bloomberg Finance LP. LME & COMEX positioning combined

Figure 35: China's Yangshan copper cathode premium



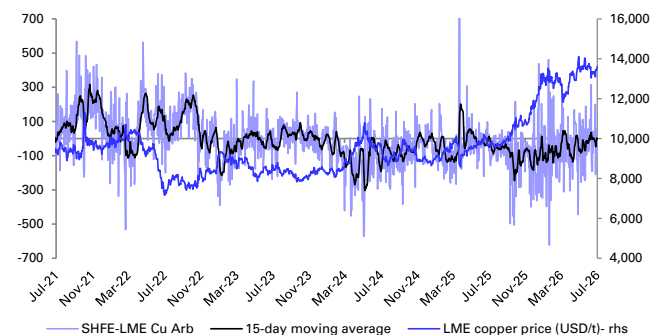
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 36: China spot TCs have collapsed due to tightness in the concentrate market and refined capacity expansions



Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 37: SHFE-LME arbitrage (USD/t)

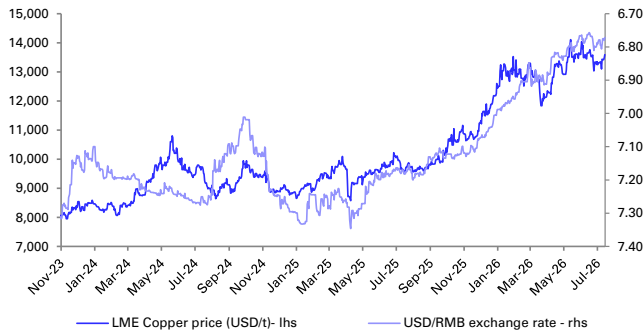


Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP



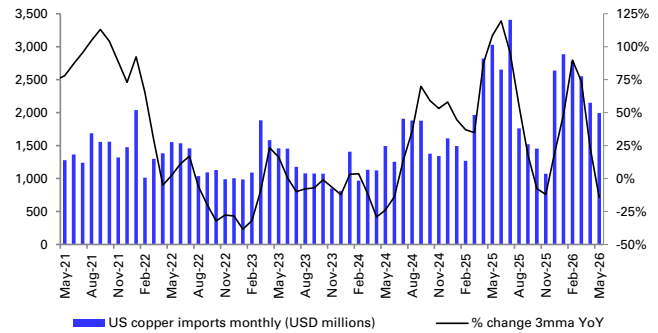
US price trends and supply trends

Figure 38: Copper price vs USD/RMB



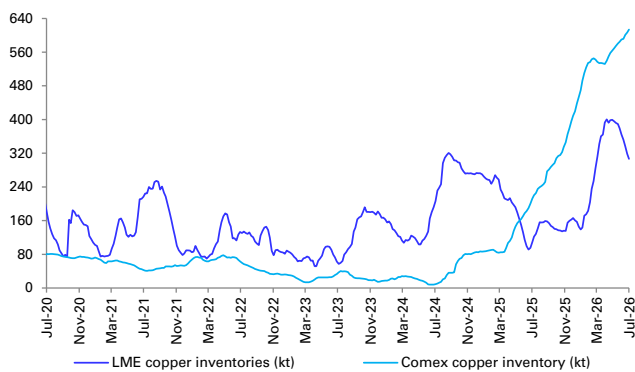
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 39: US copper imports monthly



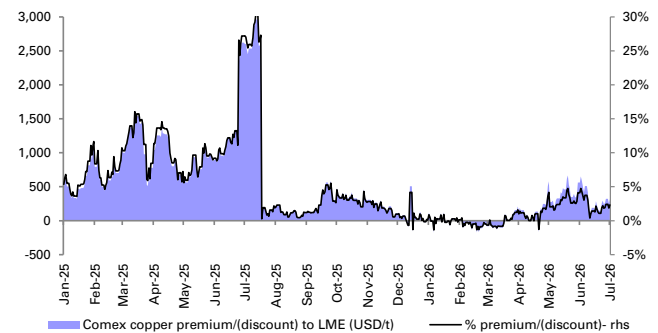
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 40: LME & COMEX copper inventories



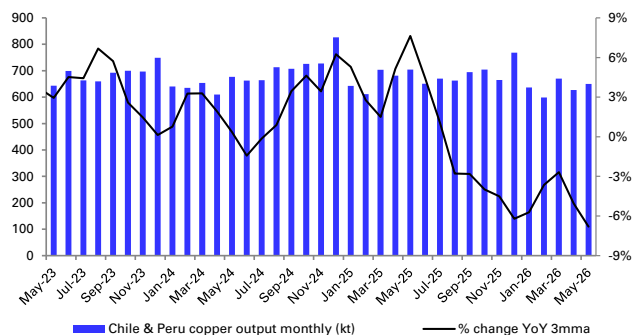
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 41: Comex copper price premium over LME



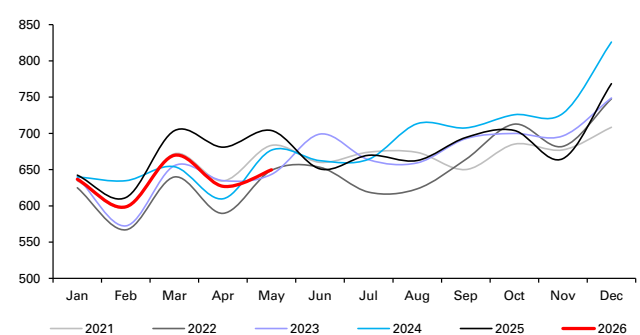
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 42: Chile and Peru combined monthly copper output



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Cochilco.cl, MINEM

Figure 43: Chile and Peru combined seasonal copper output

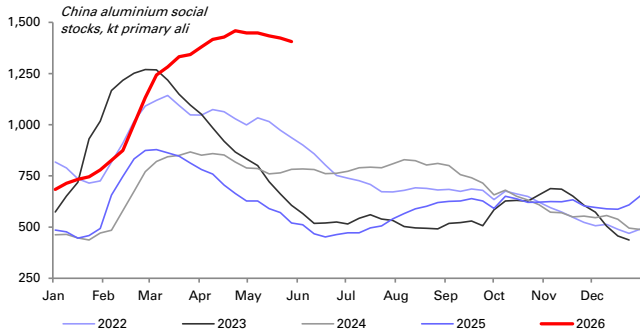


Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Cochilco.cl, MINEM



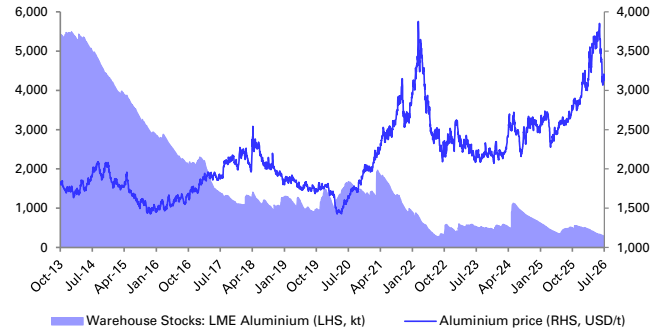
Aluminium: passing the peak

Figure 44: China domestic stocks



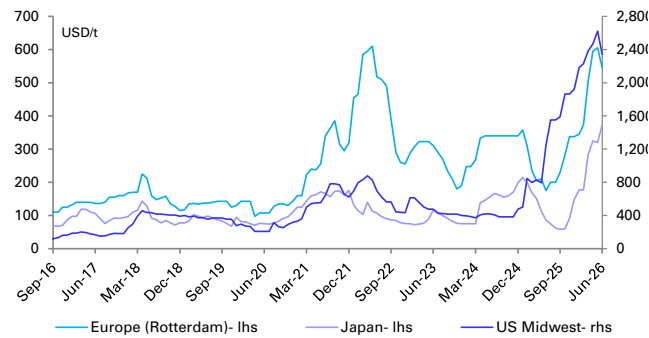
Source : Deutsche Bank, Wind

Figure 45: LME aluminium inventory and price



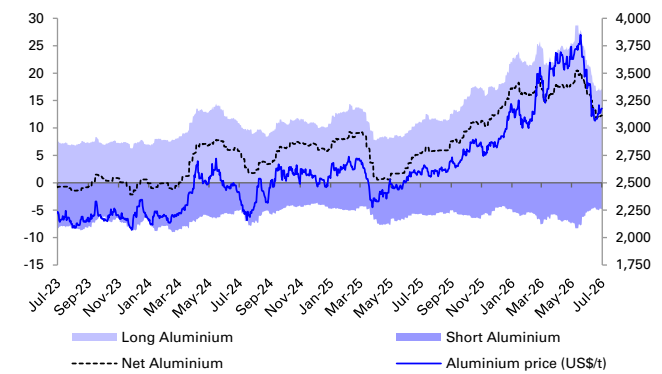
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 46: Regional physical premiums



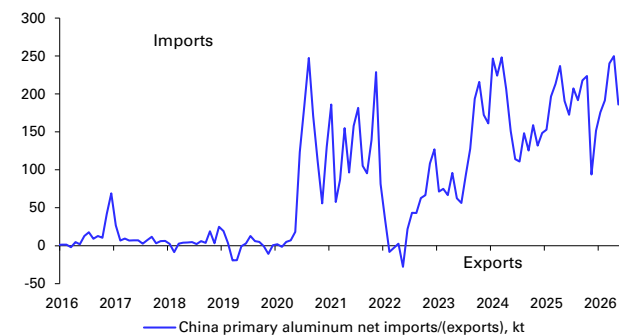
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 47: Aluminium positioning



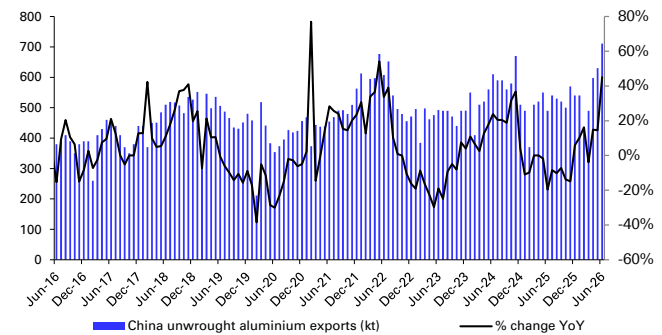
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 48: Primary imports into China (largely Russian material)



Source : Deutsche Bank, China Customs, Wind

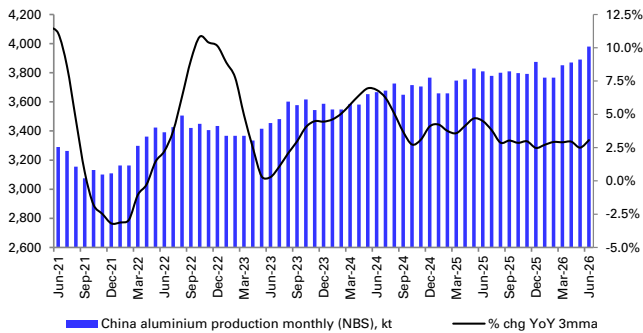
Figure 49: Semi exports from China



Source : Deutsche Bank, China Customs, Bloomberg Finance LP

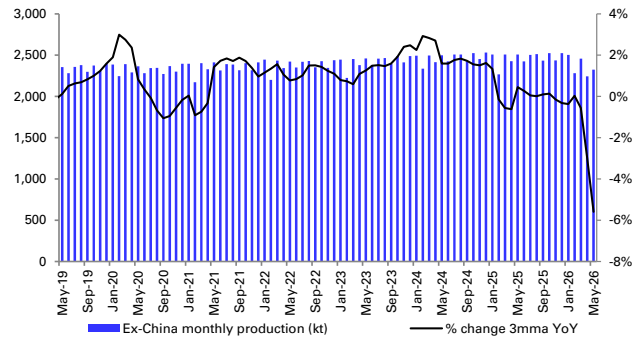


Figure 50: China monthly aluminium output



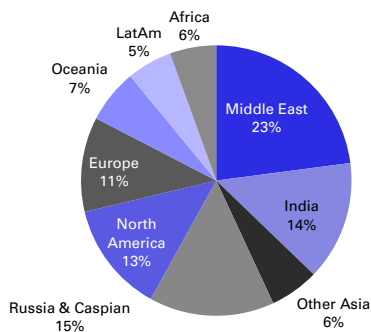
Source : Deutsche Bank, China Customs, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 51: Ex-China monthly aluminium output



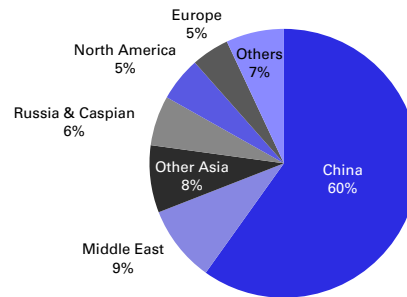
Source : Deutsche Bank, IAI

Figure 52: Ex-China primary aluminium production split by region (2025)



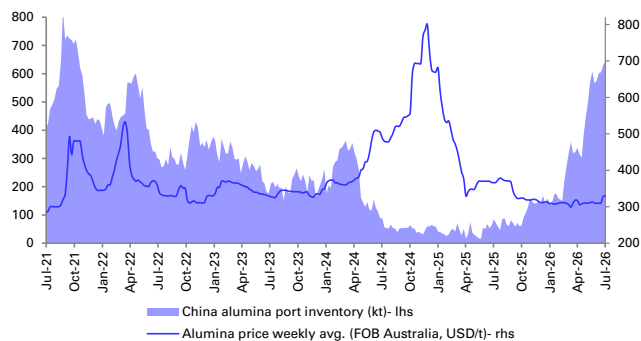
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 53: Global primary aluminium production split by region (2025)



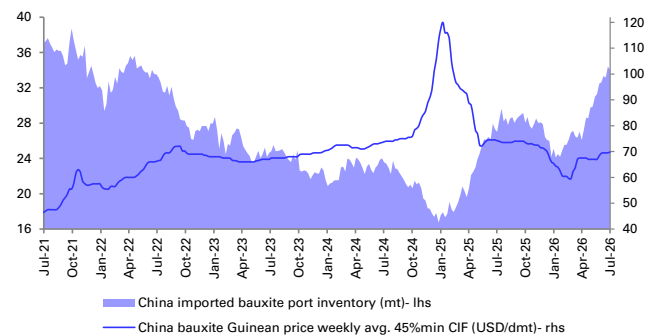
Source : Deutsche Bank, Wood Mackenzie

Figure 54: China alumina port inventory vs price



Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 55: China bauxite port inventory vs price



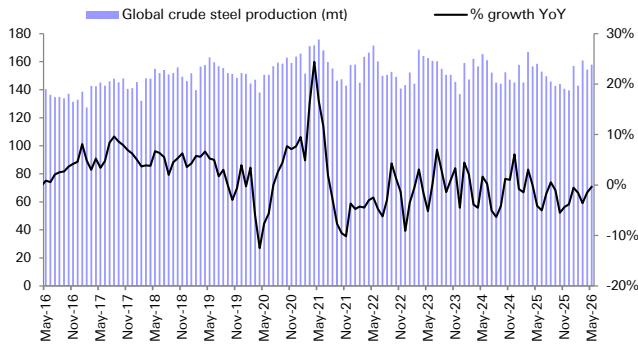
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP



Iron ore: war drivers fading

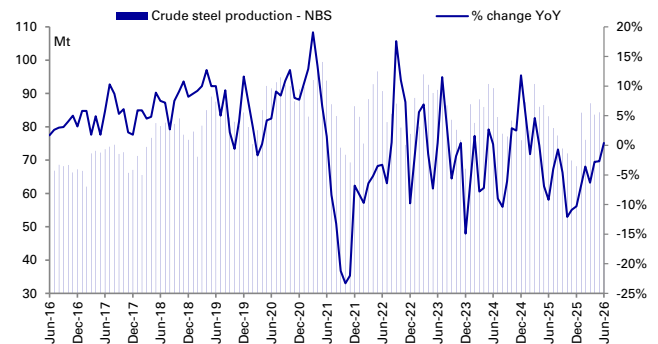
Global steel

Figure 56: Global monthly crude steel production



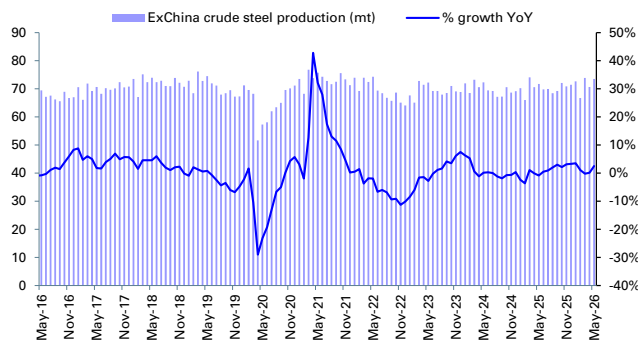
Source : Deutsche Bank, WSA

Figure 57: NBS China crude steel output



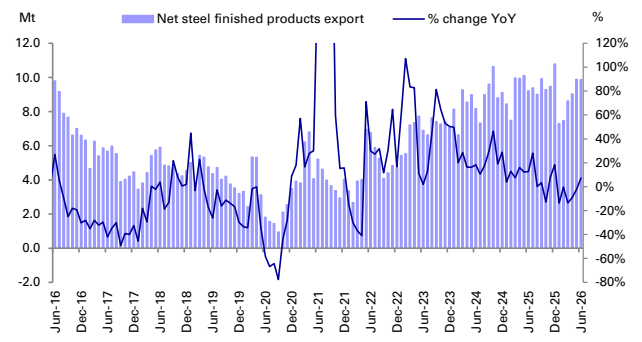
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP, NBS

Figure 58: Ex-China crude steel output



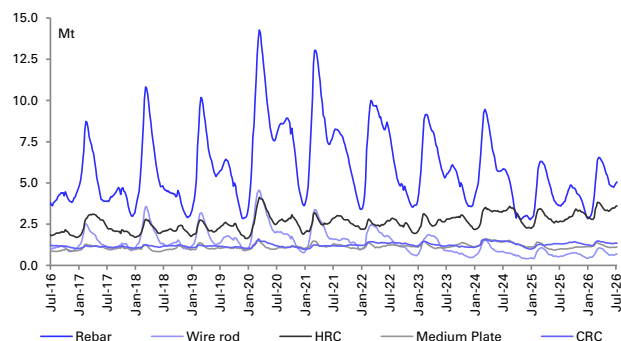
Source : Deutsche Bank, WSA

Figure 59: China net steel exports



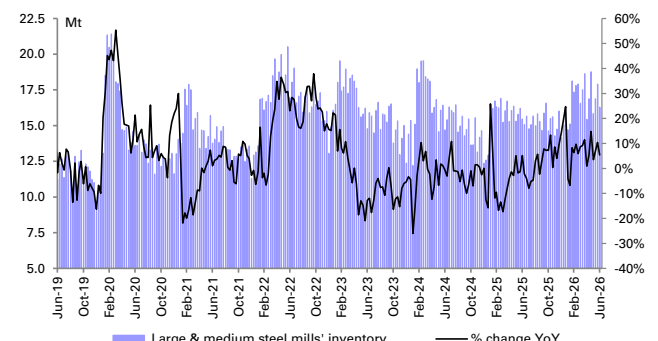
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 60: China traders' steel inventory in 26 major cities



Source : Deutsche Bank, Mysteel, Wind

Figure 61: CISA large and medium steel mills inventory (mt) (10 days)

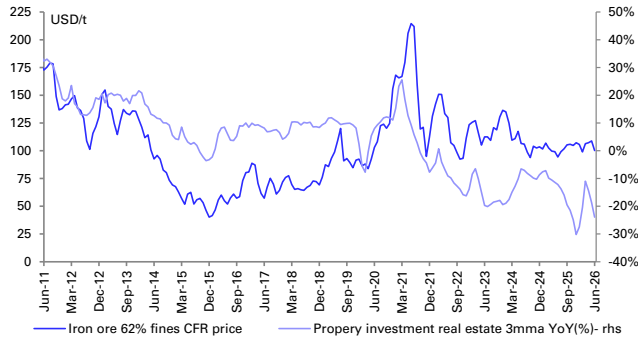


Source : Deutsche Bank, CISA, Bloomberg Finance LP



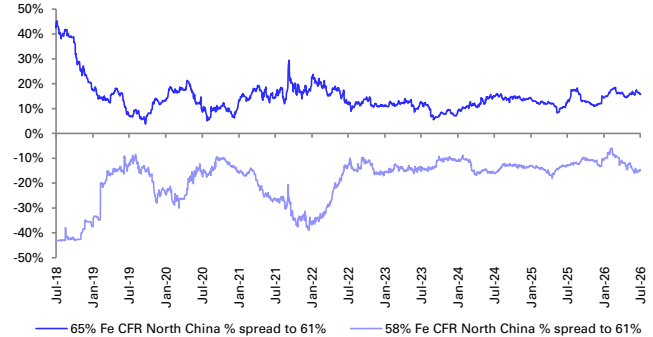
Iron ore prices and exports from Australia and Brazil

Figure 62: Iron ore price vs property investment 3mma YoY



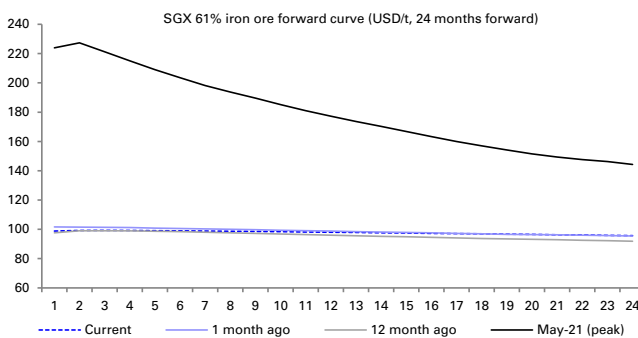
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 63: Iron ore grade differentials (as a % of benchmark 61% Fe price)



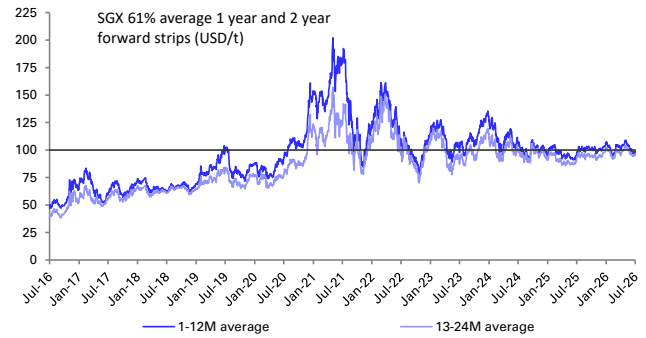
Source : Deutsche Bank, Wind

Figure 64: SGX iron ore 61% forward curve (USD/t)



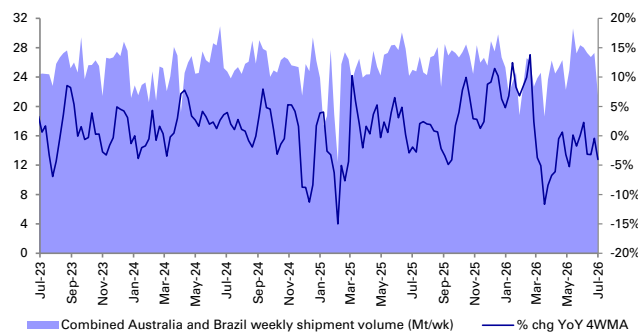
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 65: SGX iron ore 61% front 12-month and second 12-month strip average prices



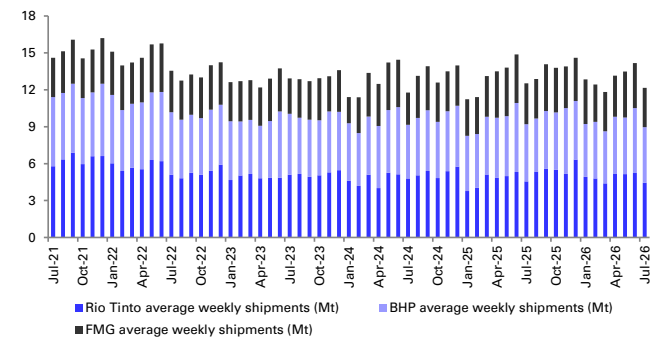
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 66: Combined iron ore weekly Australia and Brazil shipment volumes (Mt per week)



Source : Deutsche Bank, Wind

Figure 67: Australia weekly average shipment breakdown by major (Mt per week)

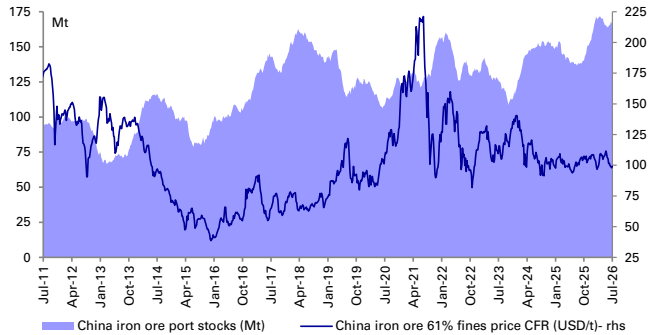


Source : Deutsche Bank, Wind



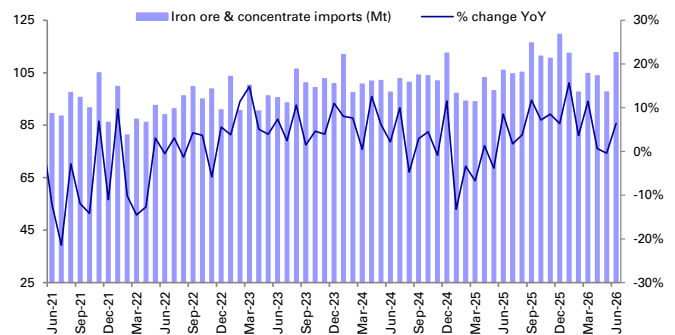
China iron ore port stocks, imports and mine output

Figure 68: China port stocks (Mt, by origin) and 61% fines landed price (USD/t)



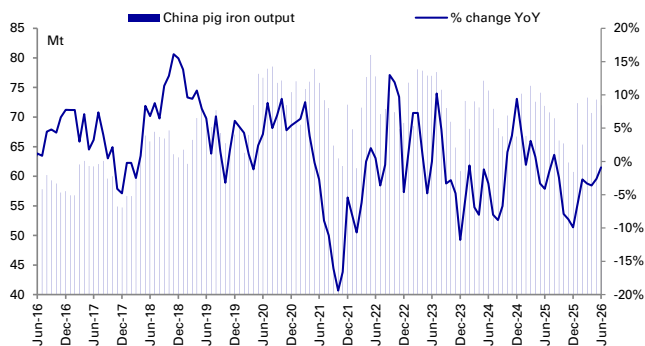
Source : Deutsche Bank, Wind

Figure 69: China iron ore imports (Mt per month)



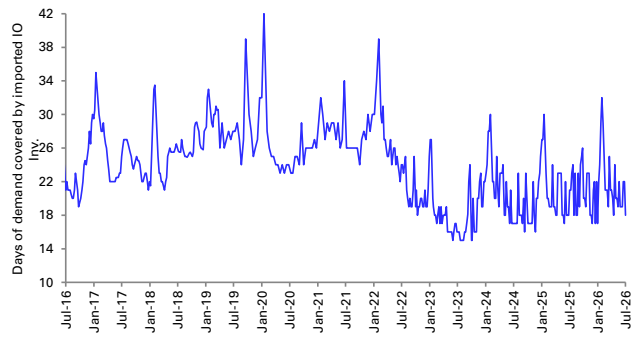
Source : Deutsche Bank, NBS, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 70: China pig iron output (Mt)



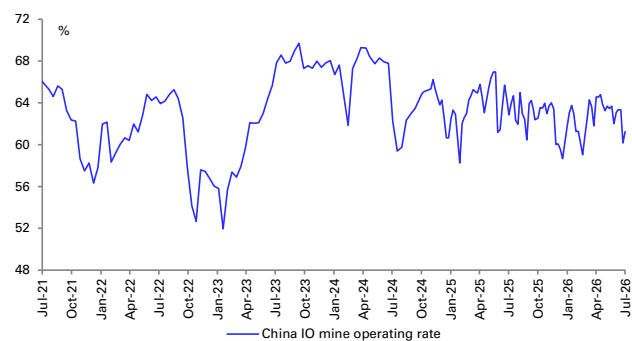
Source : Deutsche Bank, Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 71: China mill iron ore stocks (in days of consumption)



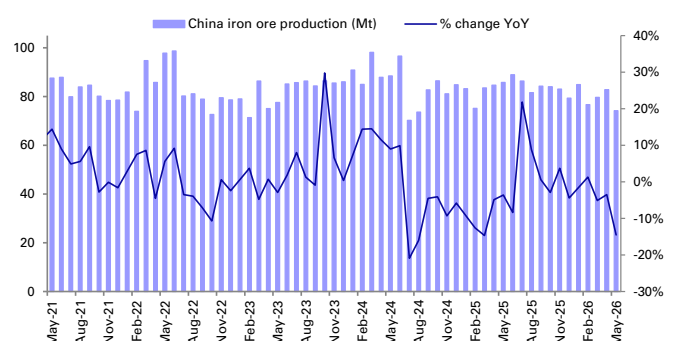
Source : Deutsche Bank, Wind

Figure 72: China iron ore mine operating rate (%)



Source : Deutsche Bank, Wind

Figure 73: China iron ore domestic output monthly (Mt)

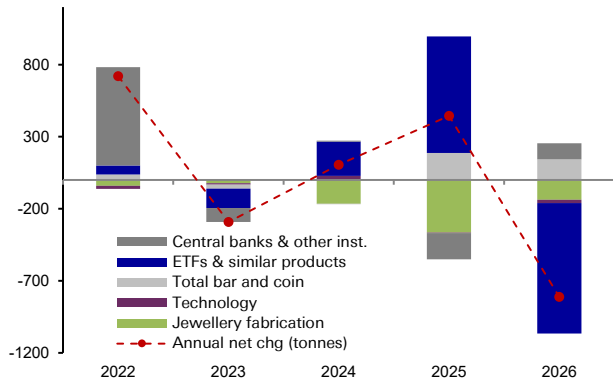


Source : Deutsche Bank, Wind, Bloomberg Finance LP



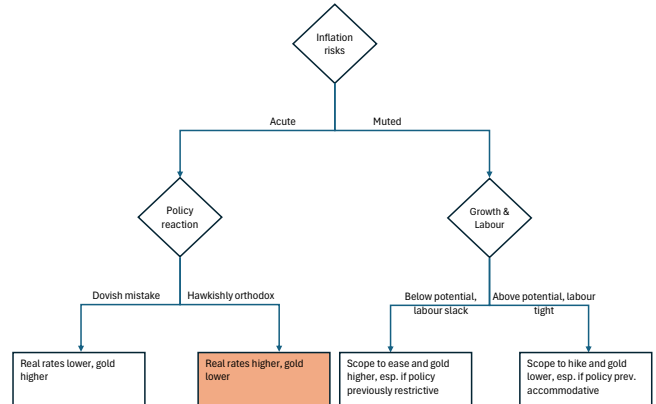
Gold and silver: Limits to Fed hawkishness

Figure 74: Weaker ETF demand dominates (tonnes)



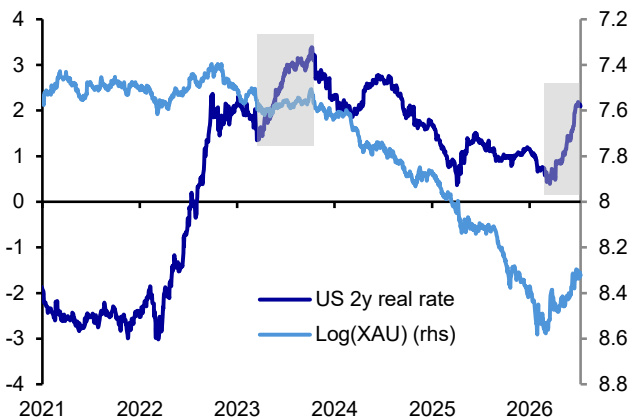
Source : World Gold Council, Deutsche Bank

Figure 75: Inflation, macro and labour market context



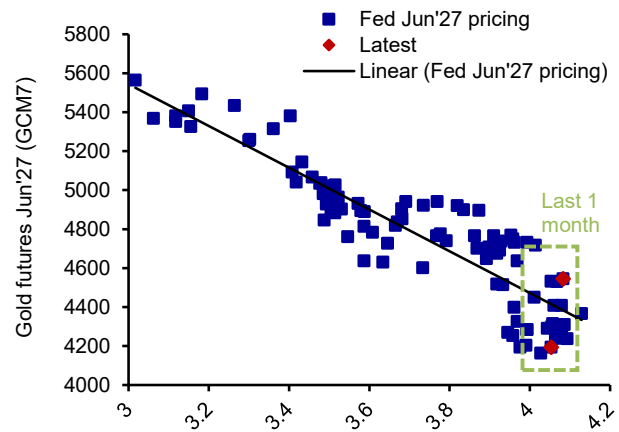
Source : Deutsche Bank

Figure 76: Gold stronger reaction to similar real rate move than in 2023 (gold rhs log scale)



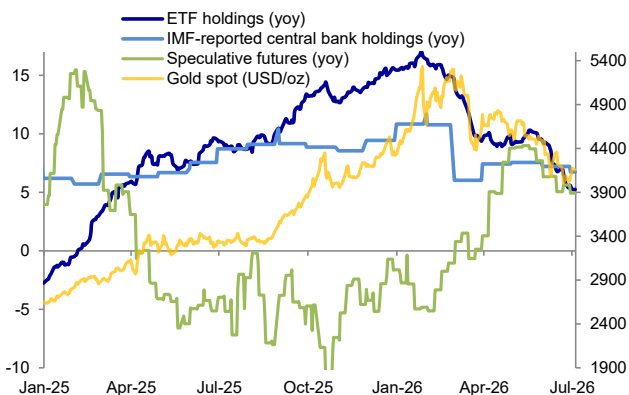
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 77: Gold moves vs Fed pricing show considerable latitude around regression



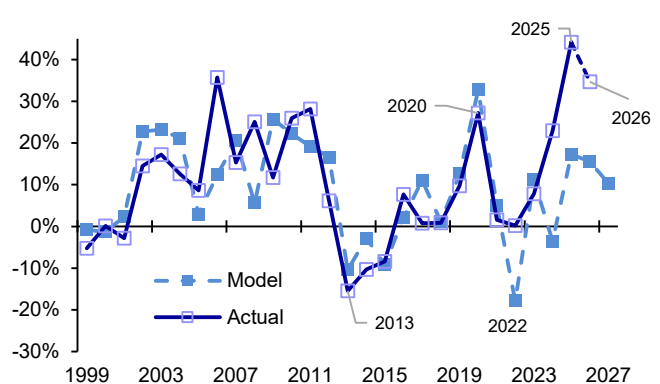
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 78: Investment demand weakened (mm troy oz)



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 79: Annual gold model implies further upside

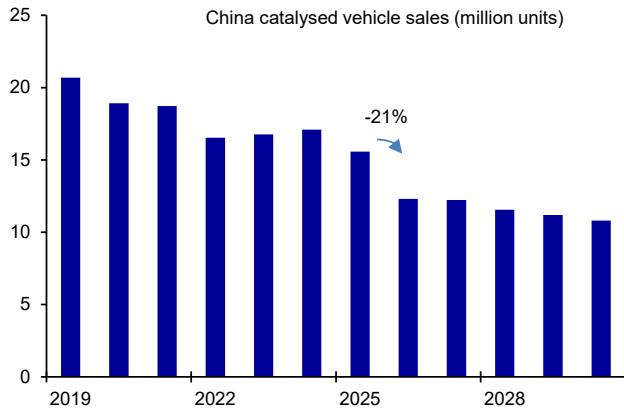


Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank



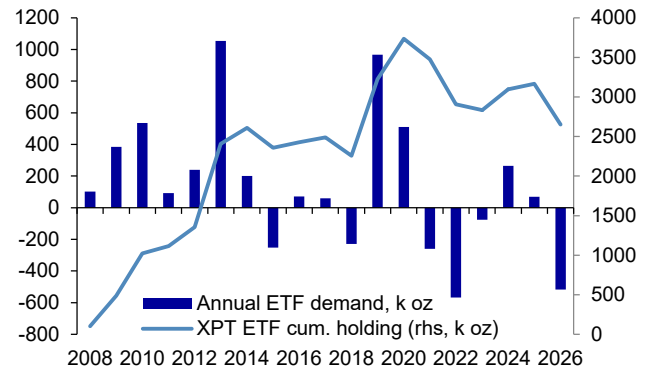
PGMs: Auto sales weakness on higher oil

Figure 80: China drives global -4.6% drop in vehicle sales



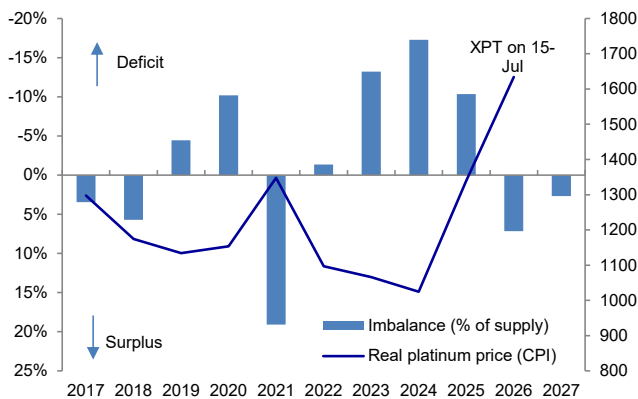
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, ACEA, JATO, Bureau of Economic Analysis, CATARC, JAMA, Marklines

Figure 81: Second-weakest year of platinum ETF demand



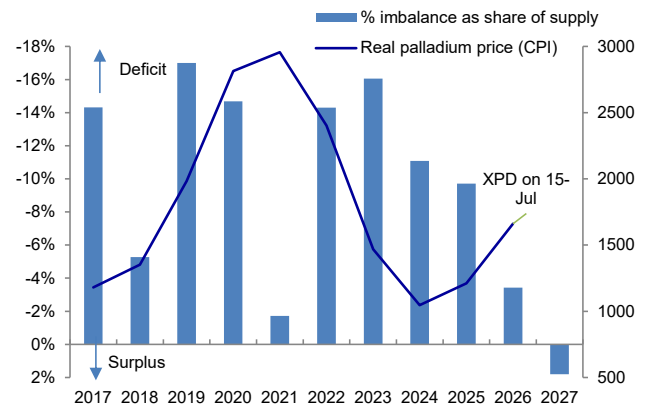
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 82: Platinum in surplus (incl. ETF investment, k oz)



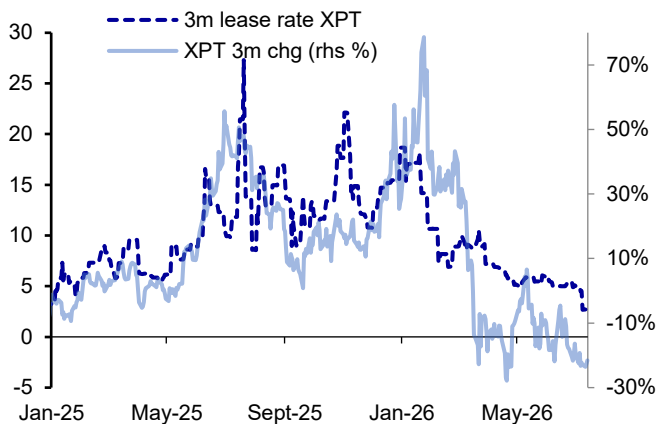
Source : Johnson Matthey, SFA Oxford, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 83: Palladium in last year of deficit (k oz)



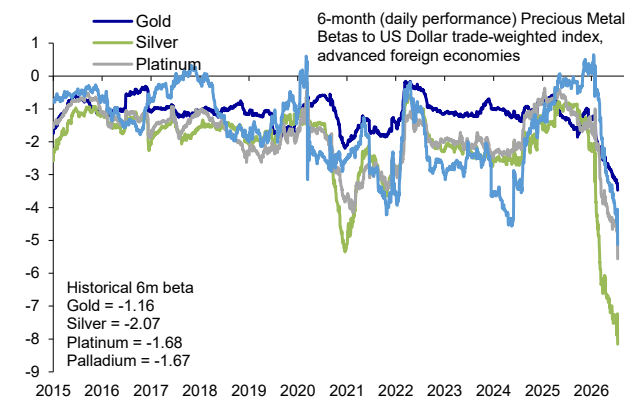
Source : Johnson Matthey, SFA Oxford, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 84: Normalisation in lease rates



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 85: Record precious metal betas to USD

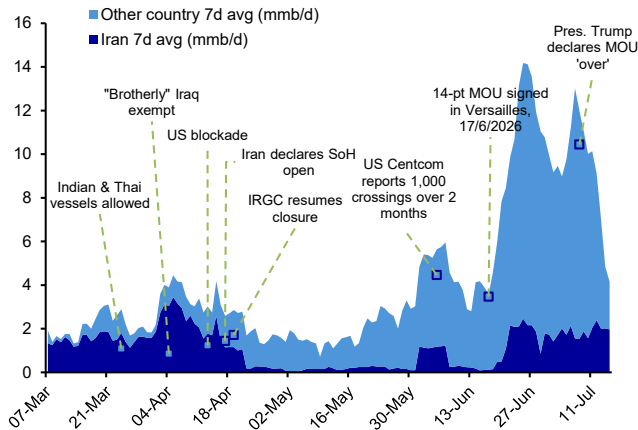


Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank



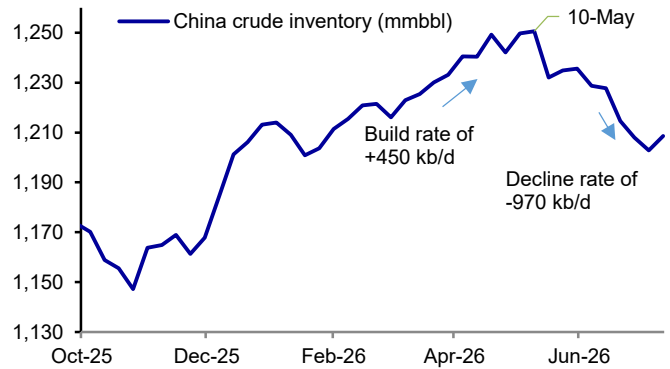
Crude oil: Refined product tightness persists

Figure 86: Strait of Hormuz exports drop



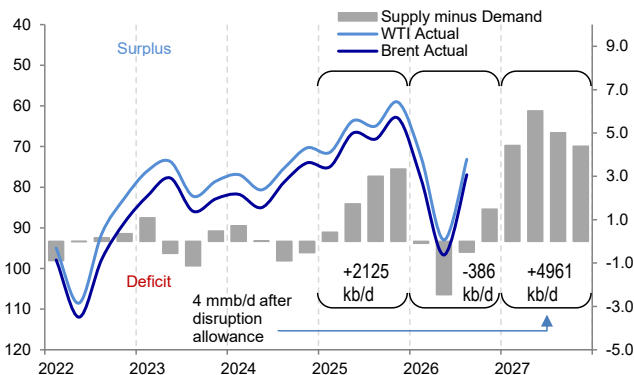
Source : Kpler, Deutsche Bank

Figure 87: China crude inventory providing swing



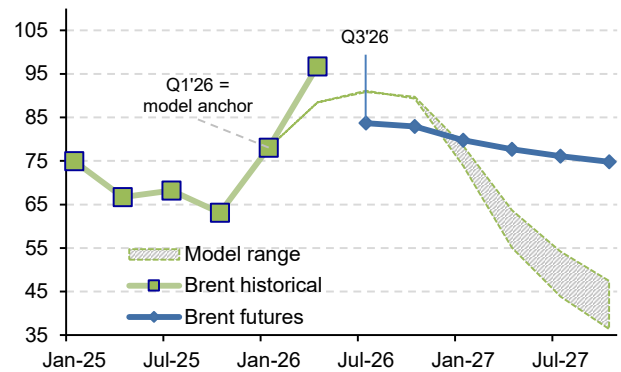
Source : Kpler, Deutsche Bank

Figure 88: Oil surplus conditions in 2027



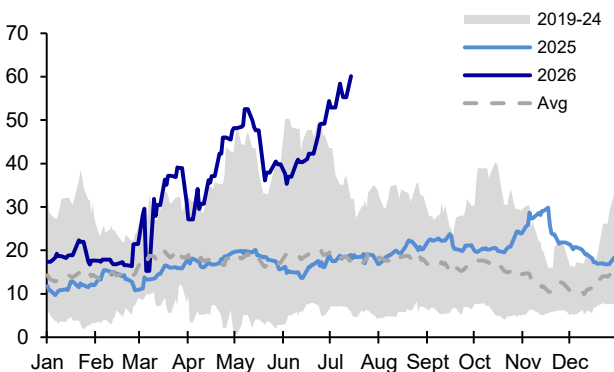
Source : IEA Monthly Oil Market Report, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 89: Model quantifies bearish outlook



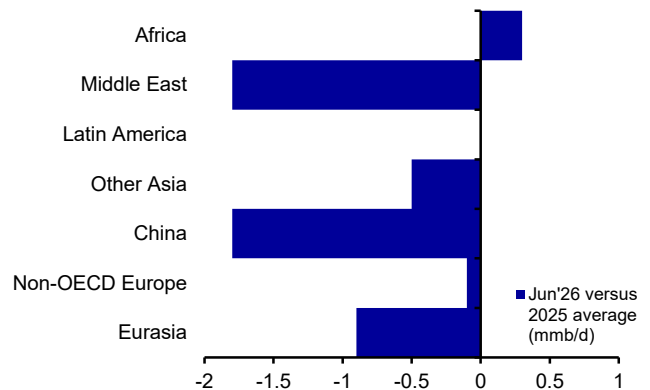
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 90: Strong refinery crack spreads (LLS 3-2-1)



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 91: Disruption to refinery runs persisted in June



Source : IEA Monthly Oil Market Report, Deutsche Bank



Research contribution

The authors of this report wish to acknowledge the contribution made by Aravinth Palanisamy, an employee of Acuity Knowledge Services, a third-party provider to Deutsche Bank of offshore research support services.



Appendix 1

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